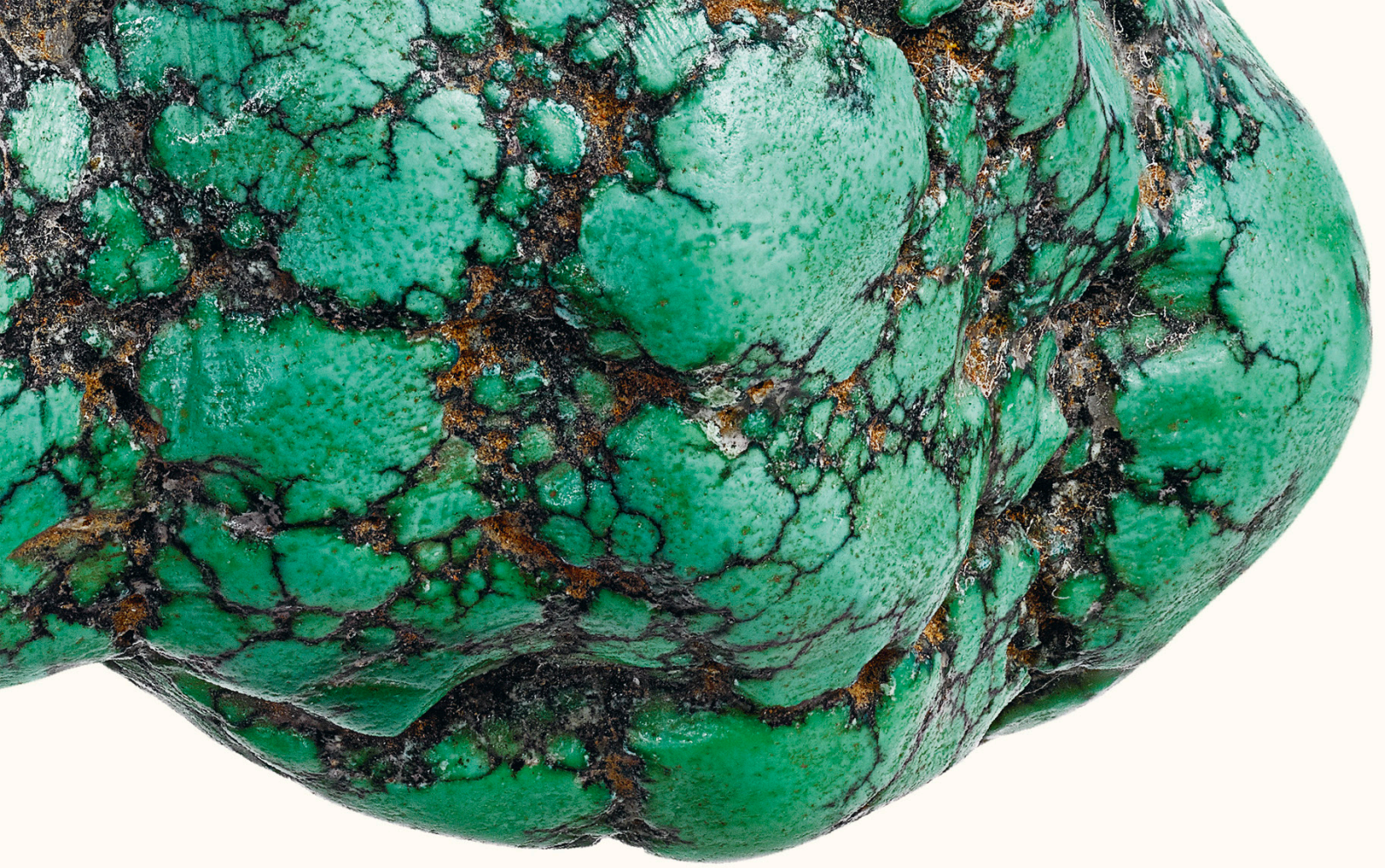




Turquoise

Greeny-blue or bluey-green? It's hard to decide, because turquoise is a mixture of both colours. The lovely blue and green in turquoise comes from two metals – copper and iron. If there is more iron, it is greener, and if there is more copper, it is bluer.

Turquoise was one of the first gems to be dug out of rocks by humans. Turquoise beads 7,000 years old have been found in the Middle East. The Aztec people of Mexico made necklaces, masks, and other objects from turquoise. They associated it with the gods, including the fire god Xiuhtecuhtli – which means “Turquoise Lord”.

